Writing Focus Statements

Concept

A focus statement introduces the general topic and useful context between the opening hook and the specific thesis.

Topic

The broad subject: school gardens.

Focus statement

A complete sentence that orients the reader to that topic.

Thesis statement

The specific claim the essay will develop and support.

Narrowing

Move from interest → context → claim. Each sentence should connect naturally to the next.

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Example 1 | original model

Build an introduction about a school garden.

Solution / why it works

1. Hook: An unused patch of soil can become a classroom.
2. Focus: School gardens give students a space to study plants through direct observation.
3. Thesis: Our school should create a small garden because it would support science lessons and shared responsibility.
4. The focus provides context; the thesis makes the proposal and previews its reasons.

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Opening map | broad to specific

Hook

Create interest in the subject.

↓

Focus / context

Orient the reader and connect the opening to the topic.

↓

Thesis

State the specific claim or controlling idea.

Writing Focus Statements

Practice planner | introduction

Topic / audience / purpose:

Hook option A:

Hook option B:

Focus statement / bridge:

Thesis:

Writing Focus Statements

Practice | your turn

1. Choose a topic and write one focus statement without arguing your position yet.

2. Add a thesis that takes a specific position on that topic.

3. Read the pair aloud. Remove repeated wording and fill any logical gap.

Writing Focus Statements

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

For public libraries: Public libraries provide shared spaces for reading, research and community programs.

2

Possible thesis: The local library should extend its evening hours so students can use its study spaces after activities.

3

A reader should understand the topic before encountering your claim.

Source & editing note

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